

2.1 Unit description

This unit is designed to extend the student's understanding of psychology by building on what has been learnt in *Unit 1: Social and Cognitive Psychology*, together with issues about relevant research methodology. *Unit 2: Understanding the Individual* provides an introduction to three other approaches in psychology, the Psychodynamic Approach, the Biological Approach and the Learning Approach. This unit aims to develop the student's understanding of psychological issues of development, individual difference and biology through the approaches.

Within each approach, the sections of the unit arise from the content which includes a selection of basic concepts of the Psychodynamic, Biological and Learning Approaches.

The unit requires students to conduct practical investigations; this can be done individually, in groups or as a whole class. Students must be able to use this practical knowledge within the context of the examination, including applying this knowledge to novel situations. Therefore each practical section contains key method terms which students may be asked to apply to novel data in an examination.